

initiated physical affection with the adult	responded warmly to adult greetings	showed preference for a specific adult
sought adult help when frustrated		

3. Communication & Language

Objective terms for documenting how a child communicates — expressively and receptively.

Note the child's primary communication mode, specific examples, and the context. Document the child's approximate vocabulary, use of sentences, and how others respond.

Expressive Language — What the Child Produces		
used single words	used two-word combinations	used short sentences (3–4 words)
used complete sentences	used gestures only	used pointing to indicate needs
used vocalizations without words	approximated words (e.g., said '___' for '___')	echoed adult speech (immediate echolalia)
repeated phrases from books or videos	asked questions using 'what' 'where' 'why'	named objects
described actions	shared experiences verbally	communicated using a device or picture symbols
used sign language	combined words and gestures	initiated conversation
responded to conversational partner		

Receptive Language — How the Child Understands		
followed a one-step direction	followed a two-step direction	followed a three-step direction with visual support
responded to their name	responded to name after ___ attempts	identified objects when named
pointed to pictures when named	understood positional concepts (on, under, beside)	followed classroom routines without verbal prompting
required visual or gestural cue to follow direction	did not respond to verbal direction alone	looked toward sound or voice
understood simple questions		

Fluency & Articulation (Describe, Do Not Diagnose)		
speech was understood by familiar adults	speech was understood by unfamiliar adults	speech required clarification ___ times during observation
repeated initial sounds or syllables	paused frequently before responding	spoke in a soft voice
spoke very loudly in all settings	varied volume and tone	spoke at a very fast rate

spoke at a very slow rate		
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Pragmatics — Social Use of Language		
maintained eye contact during conversation	took conversational turns	stayed on topic for ____ turns
shifted topics abruptly	greeted peers or adults	used language to request, comment, and protest
narrated own play aloud	asked for help verbally	responded to peer initiations
initiated interactions with peers		